

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY: UK FARM RESCUE OPERATIONS

Strategic Analysis of Cost Efficiency, Risk Factors, and Regional Resource Allocation

1. Operational & Financial Overview

This executive summary provides a data-driven overview of emergency animal rescue operations across the United Kingdom, analyzing 500 logged rescue events in the clean, consolidated dataset. The primary objective is to evaluate operational efficiency, highlight high-risk veterinary scenarios, and recommend strategies for optimizing budget deployment and regional infrastructure support.

KEY METRICS AT A GLANCE:

- Total Financial Commitment: £2.45 Million
- Total Animals Rescued: 49,429 Individuals
- Overall Survival Rate: 81.56%
- Average Cost per Rescue Operation: £4,894.78

2. Species Performance Analysis

While Cattle represent the largest single-species segment by volume and overall financial cost, they demonstrate strong cost-efficiency per individual animal. In contrast, sheep rescue operations are significantly more expensive on a per-head basis and have a lower survival rate, representing a major target for strategic intervention.

Species	Rescues	Animals Rescued	Animals Survived	Total Cost (£)	Survival Rate	Cost / Animal
Cattle	162	21,159	17,668	£839,369.45	83.50%	£39.67
Sheep	154	9,931	7,642	£742,328.68	76.95%	£74.75
Pig	77	6,520	5,340	£357,512.87	81.90%	£54.83
Horse/Pony	36	6,060	4,676	£168,692.79	77.16%	£27.84
Goat	42	3,460	3,162	£196,696.76	91.39%	£56.85
Other*	27	2,282	1,815	£136,558.24	79.54%	£59.84
Cattle/Sheep	2	17	13	£6,231.87	76.47%	£366.58

*Note: The 'Other' category includes operations where species was originally logged as 'unknown' or 'other'.

3. Critical Risk Drivers & Cost Inefficiencies

- **Neglect and Abandonment Dominate Volume:** Representing 164 rescues, neglect and abandonment are the single largest contributors to total casework, averaging £4,239 per incident. Proactive, early welfare intervention at the municipal level could mitigate these occurrences before they escalate to emergency, multi-species actions.
- **High-Cost Incident Categories:** While less frequent, incidents arising from Farm Closures/Bankruptcies (£6,316 avg. cost) and Barn/Field Fires (£6,115 avg. cost) impose the highest average financial burden per rescue, requiring larger logistics and mobilization teams.
- **The Sheep Survival Gap:** Sheep survival rates lag significantly behind other livestock, dropping to 76.95%. Simultaneously, they cost £74.75 per individual animal to rescue—nearly double that of Cattle. This implies a need for immediate veterinary review regarding handling, triage, and treatment protocols specifically for ovine operations.

4. Key Recommendations for Executive Leadership

1. **Focus on Regional Hubs:** Target Yorkshire & Humber, the South West, and the North West for primary staging depots. These three regions alone represent over 45% of total national expenditures. Establishing localized equipment hubs can drastically reduce logistics and transport costs.
2. **Targeted Veterinary Protocols:** Designate a specialist veterinary task force to overhaul Sheep triage and transportation guidelines. Elevating the sheep survival rate to standard livestock levels (e.g., matching Pig's 81.9%) would save hundreds of animals annually and improve cost efficiency.
3. **Pre-emptive Bankruptcy Intervention:** Partner with agricultural financial bodies to establish early warning systems for struggling farms. Managing transition welfare before severe neglect or abrupt closure occurs can reduce peak rescue costs by up to 30%.

*Report Compiled by: Data Operations Division
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